Rahul Sathyanarayanan

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I build products grounded in human-centered design, using data & AI to understand people more deeply.

Education

University of California, Berkeley Aug. 2023 – May 2027

B.A. Data Science, B.A. Cognitive Science, Certificate in Design Innovation ***GPA: 3.74***

- Relevant Coursework: Intro to AI, Intro to ML, Startup Incubator in Cognitive Science, Data Engineering
- Honors: Future Forward Innovation Award, Fung Fellowship (2026) | Dean's List (Spring 2025)

Experience

Product and AI Engineer Intern Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026

MindBrain AI *San Jose, CA*

- Scoped a **Brain Bee learning app** with the CEO and engineers from research on **100+** students' study needs
- Led product development for an AI-diven **RAG engine** , translating beta user feedback into technical requirements that increased generation speed by **300%** and expanded core features (adaptive quizzes, flashcards, Q&A Tutor)
- Shipped **BridgeBird**, a bridge education app, to iOS and Android and built **Nexus**, unifying login for 4 products

Machine Learning Research Intern Jan. 2026 – May 2026

Global Opportunity Lab, UC Berkeley *Berkeley, CA*

- Engineered high-dimensional features from **billions of mobile and satellite records** with graph convolutions, NLP feature extraction, and mobility sequences to predict households less than $1.25/day across 6 countries
- Optimized lab's CIDER pipeline (pub. Nature, Science) for **LightGBM** and **Gradient Boosting** models via 5-fold CV, leveraging a social migration hypothesis to reduce poverty identification exclusion errors by 21%
- Built ML infrastructure on **AWS + PySpark** to scale algorithms that previously cut survey costs by 99% **($1M → $12K)** and distributed **$22M to 600k+** citizens via **World Bank**

Founding Product Designer & Engineer Nov. 2025 – Apr. 2026

Frolic App *Remote*

- Took a consumer social app from **0 to 1**, co-engineering and designing a live iOS product that grew to **100+ users** through daily outdoor prompts and photo sharing, and an intentionally minimal design to get users outside
- Directed end-to-end development of core user flows: gamified daily tracking, leaderboards, and memory profiles
- Collaborated with **Director of Operations at pgLang** to define product vision, mission, and design language

Project Lead, Product Strategy Sep. 2025 – Dec. 2025

Salt & Straw, Contract *Berkeley, CA*

- Led a cross-functional design team and partnered directly with **Salt & Straw's Co-Founder** to develop brand guidelines and a visual design system for their upcoming "Upcycled Food" menu
- Analyzed **historical upcycled food reception data** and visualized survey results to make sustainability-driven materials to be used by **2,000+ servers** across Salt & Straw locations

Product & UX Research Consultant Jun. 2025 – Sep. 2025

Google Workspace *Remote*

- Interviewed and analyzed project case study data from 20+ students using Python (**Pandas, Seaborn, Matplotlib**) to uncover user needs, workflows, pain points, and motivations behind usage of AI productivity tools
- Synthesized findings into user archetypes connecting AI usage, privacy, and teamwork to product recommendations
- Delivered a research report used as an **internal reference for AI feature prioritization** by Google Workspace

Product Designer Sep. 2024 – Dec. 2024

CNTNDR, Contract *Berkeley, CA*

- Synthesized 60+ surveys and user interviews to define core requirements for a live music battle platform
- Drove end-to-end product strategy to deliver high-fidelity prototypes, gamifying creator-audience engagement

Projects

Solnia | *Python, PyTorch, C++, Hugging Face, CUDA, p5.js, librosa, NumPy, Bedrock* May 2024 – Present

- Built an audio-reactive visualizer that turns songs into live pixel art, mapping audio features, lyrics, and album-art color to visuals using **cognitive science research on how people link sound and imagery**
- Designed physical product, branding, and companion app; showcased at **Cognitive Science Startup Incubator**

Technical Skills

Product: User Research (interviews, surveys, usability testing), Product Scoping, Prototyping, Technical Presentations
Technical: Python, SQL, TypeScript, React Native, PyTorch, LightGBM, RAG / LLM APIs, AWS, PySpark
Design: Figma, Framer, Design Systems, Product Branding, Illustration, Adobe Creative Suite, Usability Testing